RCS Billing categories

How is an RCS-message invoiced the account that owns the RCS-agent?

There are two types of billing categories:

1. Conversational
2. Non-conversational

As of March 2026: The Non-conversational billing category has officially replaced the legacy categories. The legacy **basic message** and **single message** categories are now deprecated.

Google is the company behind the RCS-protocol. This explanation is from their documentation on Billing categories:

Billing category	Agent type	Example use cases	Billing method
Non-conversational	Agents that primarily send one-way messages	• OTPs • Alerts • Promotional offers	Billed per message.
Conversational	Agents that are designed for back-and-forth exchanges with users	• Finding the right product • Booking a ticket • Troubleshooting an issue	**Billed per conversation**: If one party (the agent or user) replies to a message from the other party within 24 hours, a conversation starts. During the conversation window (24 hours after the first reply), the agent and user can exchange any number of messages, and the agent will be billed a fixed rate for the conversation. **Billed per message**: If the agent delivers a message that the user doesn't reply to within 24 hours, the agent will be billed for the individual message, similar to a non-conversational agent.

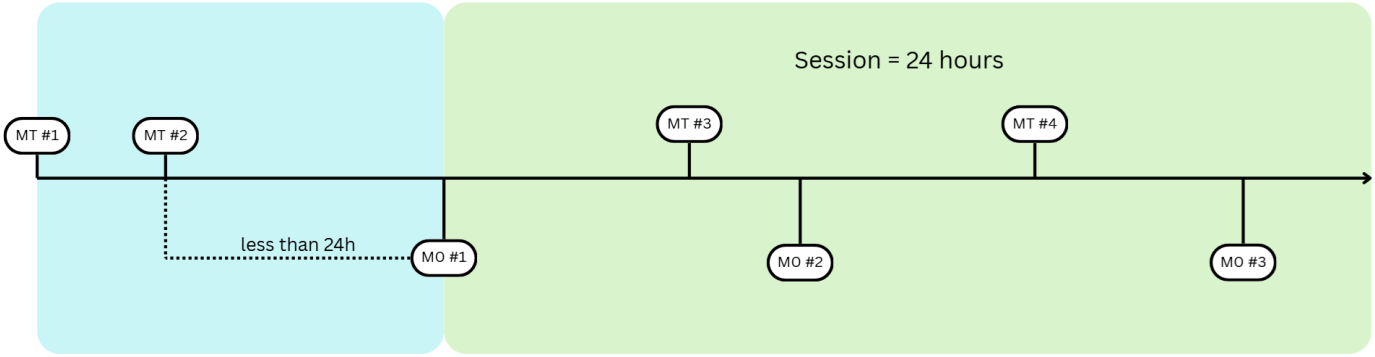
What type of RCS-agent should you choose? Simply put: If you expect/want your customer (i.e. the end user) to reply to the RCS-messages you send out and establish a dialogue, choose a Conversational agent. If you do not expect/want your customer to reply, choose a Non-conversational agent.

<u>How conversations work</u>

- **Start**: A conversation begins when one party (the agent or user) responds to a message from the other party within 24 hours of receiving it, outside of any existing conversation.
    - **A2P conversation**: Starts when the user responds to the agent's message.
    - **P2A conversation**: Starts when the agent responds to the user's message.

- **Conversation window**: The conversation remains active for 24 hours after it started. The conversation includes all messages within this 24-hour window, as well as the very first message that was initially responded to.
- **Billing**: Instead of billing for each individual message, conversational agents are billed based on the entire conversation. This means the cost is associated with the conversation thread, not the number of messages within it.

RCS Billing Categories



Invoicing if agent is Conversational billing category:

Before a session is started

Session is started when end-user replies. Session lasts 24 hours, but invoicing includes MT #2 . MT #1 is invoiced as Single or Basic RCS. All messages within session are covered by the conversation price

Important note: If RCS-agent is in billing category Non-conversational, all MTs are invoiced as Single or Basic RCS